

Instrument Flight Instructor

Flight Lesson Guide

The student in this route is the instructor candidate; the instructor is the qualified trainer who can role-play a learner. The candidate prepares and teaches a measurable preflight lesson, demonstrates while explaining, supervises practice, diagnoses errors and assesses the result. Timing is an adjustable plan. Aircraft inspection/preparation, parked briefing and debrief are separate from the flight block; flight includes taxi, departure/transit, practice and safe return. Repeat or defer tasks until proficiency is demonstrated, and meet actual regulatory experience/endorsement requirements independently.

Original SUAREZ.CFI progression using FAA standards and handbooks; reviewed October 10, 2026. Instructor-route time allocations are teaching proposals.

Use this guide

Read the full teaching guide before flight. Use the compact checklist to sequence the flight. Minutes are pacing targets; repeat, stop, or defer an exercise when proficiency, conditions, or available time require it. Checkmarks indicate items covered, not a proficiency endorsement.

Aircraft values come from the applicable POH/AFM and approved checklist. Brief the aircraft-specific speeds, configurations, limitations, and any simulation method before conducting a maneuver.

Entry and preparation

- Determine whether this is an initial instrument-instructor application or an additional rating and apply 61.183/61.187/61.191 and the correct PTS scope.
- Verify the required pilot/instructor instrument ratings, aircraft category/class, trainer authority and actual-IFR or simulated-IFR legality.
- Complete weather, IFR regulations, flight planning, instruments/equipment and records/endorsement preparation before the relevant flight.
- When simulated instrument flight is used, brief qualified lookout/control responsibilities and meet the applicable 91.109 requirements; do not restrict the observing pilot's vision.
- For a multiengine applicant/aircraft, determine whether PTS emergency tasks IX.C-D are required; the conditional multiengine lesson becomes applicable required training when those tasks are in scope.

Sources and alignment

Flight Instructor Instrument PTS - FAA-S-8081-9E, April 2024; effective May 31, 2024; index reviewed October 10, 2026

Flight Instructor for Airplane Category ACS - FAA-S-ACS-25, April 2024; effective May 31, 2024; index reviewed October 10, 2026

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020); FAA index reviewed October 10, 2026

Airplane Flying Handbook and current addenda - FAA-H-8083-3C (2021), October 2025 addendum listed; index reviewed October 10, 2026

Instrument handbooks, errata and addenda - FAA-H-8083-15B and listed errata/addenda; FAA-H-8083-16B; index reviewed October 10, 2026

Historical FAA FITS generic instructor progression - December 2007; historical pedagogy framework, not current approval or standards

Flight instructor eligibility and proficiency rules - Current eCFR; verify for the specific applicant

Certification and endorsement guidance - AC 61-65K, November 2025; verify current FAA status before endorsement

Instrument Rating - Airplane ACS: instrument proficiency check - FAA-S-ACS-8C; FAA index April 2024/effective May 31, 2024; reviewed October 10, 2026

Lesson index

Instrument control and teaching baseline

- 1 · Establish instrument-instructor baseline · 90 min dual
- 2 · Coach instrument control and precise transitions · 90 min dual
- 3 · Teach unusual attitudes and a lost-indication transition · 90 min dual

Procedures and approach instruction

- 4 · Teach navigation-source selection and tracking · 90 min dual
- 5 · Teach holdings, departures and clearance amendments · 90 min dual
- 6 · Teach nonprecision approach planning · 90 min dual
- 7 · Teach precision guidance and mode awareness · 90 min dual
- 8 · Teach circling, visual transitions and missed decisions · 90 min dual

Integration and instructor assessment

- 9 · Lead an IFR instructional mission with abnormalities · 120 min dual
- 10 · Plan an IPC and teach selected proficiency segments · 120 min dual
- 11 · Mock instrument-instructor assessment · 120 min check
- 12 · Conditional multiengine instrument instruction · 120 min dual

Instrument control and teaching baseline

Verify instrument proficiency and teach reliable scan, control and failure recognition.

Lesson 1 · Establish instrument-instructor baseline

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Teach instrument checks and taxi clearance	Candidate explains the instrument checks, clearance route and taxi plan; confirms indications/equipment status, briefs hold-short points and stops for any...
08-23 Air 00-15	[] Teach departure and transition to instrument flight	Candidate briefs the cleared departure, flies/teaches the approved takeoff and climb, verifies navigation/modes and transitions to instrument exercise only...
23-53 Air 15-45	[] Teach basic instrument control and changes of airspeed	Teach level flight and turns, then change airspeed while preserving the path.
53-68 Air 45-60	[] Teach IFR clearances and procedure compliance	Explain the clearance limit and applicable departure/en-route/arrival path, verify chart/NOTAM/equipment suitability, set and cross-check the navigation, and...
68-85 Air 60-77	[] Complete a supported approach or visual return	Candidate teaches the authorized return, approach or visual pattern, confirms active guidance and approved configuration, makes the landing/missed decision and...
85-90 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 1

Verify instrument control and the ability to explain it before giving the candidate responsibility for learner errors.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Verify instrument control and the ability to explain it before giving the candidate responsibility for learner errors.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Verify pilot/instructor rating status, instrument experience and training-instructor authority; select the correct PTS initial/additional-rating scope.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Verify instrument control and the ability to explain it before giving the candidate responsibility for learner errors.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach instrument checks and taxi clearance · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach stationary/moving instrument checks using the aircraft checklist and verify the real clearance, navigation source and airport diagram. Act as a learner who overlooks a hold-short or source mismatch only through a verbal cue.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the instrument checks, clearance route and taxi plan; confirms indications/equipment status, briefs hold-short points and stops for any uncertainty before continuing.

Practice: One actual taxi route with each required aircraft instrument check; no head-down programming while moving.

Look for: Checks and clearance/airport route are correctly taught; taxi remains under positive control.

Watch / correct: Head-down setup while moving -> stop in a safe location before programming.

Watch / correct: Check completed without noticing an inconsistent indication -> resolve the indication before dispatch.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for unclear clearance/route, unsafe distraction, abnormal instruments or runway-incursion risk.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E III.C,V.A,X.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach departure and transition to instrument flight · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Confirm who is pilot flying and outside observer; assess the candidate's teaching of actual clearance, departure path, approved speeds/configuration and view-device timing. Prevent a scenario instruction from replacing the real clearance.

Student exercise: Candidate briefs the cleared departure, flies/teaches the approved takeoff and climb, verifies navigation/modes and transitions to instrument exercise only after workload and lookout responsibilities are established.

Practice: One authorized departure/transit; instrument time begins only under actual qualifying conditions.

Look for: Candidate teaches the correct path/configuration and establishes a stable instrument scan without losing clearance or lookout protection.

Watch / correct: Discussing the lesson while missing a clearance restriction -> fly/comply first and shorten instruction.

Watch / correct: Using a view device before a safe observer/control arrangement -> defer device use until responsibilities are clear.

Stop / transition: Discontinue the exercise for an actual clearance conflict, control deterioration, unsafe weather/equipment or lookout failure.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E V.A-B,VI; aircraft departure checklist; 91.109 as applicable

Teach basic instrument control and changes of airspeed · 30 minutes

Teach / coach: Ask the candidate to teach control/performance or primary/supporting technique using the actual instrument presentation. Act as a learner who overcontrols a small error; require concise feedback that reconnects attitude/power with the desired flight path.

Student exercise: Teach level flight and turns, then change airspeed while preserving the path. Demonstrate constant-airspeed and constant-rate climbs/descents, explaining which parameter is controlled and which instrument trend verifies it. Coach an integrated learner sequence.

Practice: One candidate demonstration sequence; one coached sequence; one focused repeat of an unstable transition.

Look for: Candidate flies to the applicable instrument skill standard while giving accurate instruction and correcting scan/control errors before they grow.

Watch / correct: Changing pitch and power repeatedly without waiting for the result -> make a purposeful change, observe and refine.

Watch / correct: Confusing constant rate with constant airspeed -> restate the assigned target and use the appropriate controlling indication.

Stop / transition: End simulated instrument conditions for traffic/lookout failure, control deterioration, disorientation or an aircraft limitation. Maintain a clearly briefed pilot flying and outside observer.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VI.A-E; Instrument Flying Handbook

Teach IFR clearances and procedure compliance · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign a realistic clearance and observe the candidate teach copying, readback, route/altitude interpretation and avionics setup. Act as a learner who accepts an ambiguous instruction; require a clarification request instead of an assumption.

Student exercise: Explain the clearance limit and applicable departure/en-route/arrival path, verify chart/NOTAM/equipment suitability, set and cross-check the navigation, and teach compliance through one amended clearance. Use simulated clearances only when their status is explicitly announced.

Practice: One complete clearance briefing and one amendment; fly the applicable procedure segment when authorized.

Look for: Candidate teaches an accurate clearance interpretation, anticipates the next restriction and seeks clarification before uncertainty changes the flight path.

Watch / correct: Reading back correctly but programming a different route -> compare the clearance, chart and active navigation.

Watch / correct: Assuming a clearance removes a published restriction without justification -> clarify and apply the current rules/procedure.

Stop / transition: No unapproved route/altitude deviation for a training script. Actual ATC instructions and aircraft limitations govern; request an alternative when unable.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E V.A-B; Instrument Procedures Handbook chapters 1-3

Complete a supported approach or visual return · 17 minutes

Teach / coach: Require a current return/approach briefing, aircraft category/equipment, minima if applicable and a missed/landing plan. Observe the candidate's final coaching and protect against fixation on the lesson timer.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches the authorized return, approach or visual pattern, confirms active guidance and approved configuration, makes the landing/missed decision and maintains positive control through rollout.

Practice: One final supported approach/landing or authorized missed/visual alternative; no forced extra approach.

Look for: Actual ATC, approach/visual rules and aircraft limits are respected; teaching stays concise during high workload.

Watch / correct: Trying to finish an explanation below an appropriate workload gate -> fly the approach and discuss later.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or unmet visual conditions -> execute the safe authorized missed/go-around.

Stop / transition: Miss/go around or use the authorized alternative for unstable flight, invalid guidance, unmet required references or runway conflict.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VIII; current charts and aircraft checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E X.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate flies to the applicable instrument skill standard while giving accurate instruction and correcting scan/control errors before they grow.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- Repair baseline control/scan deficiencies before adding partial-panel or high-workload approaches.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor Instrument PTS - source page Tasks VI.A, VI.B, VI.C, VI.D, VI.E, V.A, V.B; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-8081-9E, April 2024

Lesson 2 · Coach instrument control and precise transitions

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Teach instrument checks and taxi clearance	Candidate explains the instrument checks, clearance route and taxi plan; confirms indications/equipment status, briefs hold-short points and stops for any...
08-23 Air 00-15	[] Teach departure and transition to instrument flight	Candidate briefs the cleared departure, flies/teaches the approved takeoff and climb, verifies navigation/modes and transitions to instrument exercise only...
23-45 Air 15-37	[] Teach basic instrument control and changes of airspeed	Teach level flight and turns, then change airspeed while preserving the path.
45-55 Air 37-47	[] Teach timed turns and compass-heading errors	Teach a timed heading change at the selected authorized turn rate.
55-68 Air 47-60	[] Teach instrument steep turns	Clear the area with the observing pilot; demonstrate coordinated instrument steep turns in each direction.
68-85 Air 60-77	[] Complete a supported approach or visual return	Candidate teaches the authorized return, approach or visual pattern, confirms active guidance and approved configuration, makes the landing/missed decision and...
85-90 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 2

Teach changes of airspeed, climb/descent targets, timed headings and instrument turns with concise corrections.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Teach changes of airspeed, climb/descent targets, timed headings and instrument turns with concise corrections.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Prepare a candidate-taught instrument-control lesson using the actual panel and heading sources.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Teach changes of airspeed, climb/descent targets, timed headings and instrument turns with concise corrections.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach instrument checks and taxi clearance · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach stationary/moving instrument checks using the aircraft checklist and verify the real clearance, navigation source and airport diagram. Act as a learner who overlooks a hold-short or source mismatch only through a verbal cue.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the instrument checks, clearance route and taxi plan; confirms indications/equipment status, briefs hold-short points and stops for any uncertainty before continuing.

Practice: One actual taxi route with each required aircraft instrument check; no head-down programming while moving.

Look for: Checks and clearance/airport route are correctly taught; taxi remains under positive control.

Watch / correct: Head-down setup while moving -> stop in a safe location before programming.

Watch / correct: Check completed without noticing an inconsistent indication -> resolve the indication before dispatch.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for unclear clearance/route, unsafe distraction, abnormal instruments or runway-incursion risk.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E III.C,V.A,X.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach departure and transition to instrument flight · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Confirm who is pilot flying and outside observer; assess the candidate's teaching of actual clearance, departure path, approved speeds/configuration and view-device timing. Prevent a scenario instruction from replacing the real clearance.

Student exercise: Candidate briefs the cleared departure, flies/teaches the approved takeoff and climb, verifies navigation/modes and transitions to instrument exercise only after workload and lookout responsibilities are established.

Practice: One authorized departure/transit; instrument time begins only under actual qualifying conditions.

Look for: Candidate teaches the correct path/configuration and establishes a stable instrument scan without losing clearance or lookout protection.

Watch / correct: Discussing the lesson while missing a clearance restriction -> fly/comply first and shorten instruction.

Watch / correct: Using a view device before a safe observer/control arrangement -> defer device use until responsibilities are clear.

Stop / transition: Discontinue the exercise for an actual clearance conflict, control deterioration, unsafe weather/equipment or lookout failure.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E V.A-B,VI; aircraft departure checklist; 91.109 as applicable

Teach basic instrument control and changes of airspeed · 22 minutes

Teach / coach: Ask the candidate to teach control/performance or primary/supporting technique using the actual instrument presentation. Act as a learner who overcontrols a small error; require concise feedback that reconnects attitude/power with the desired flight path.

Student exercise: Teach level flight and turns, then change airspeed while preserving the path. Demonstrate constant-airspeed and constant-rate climbs/descents, explaining which parameter is controlled and which instrument trend verifies it. Coach an integrated learner sequence.

Practice: One candidate demonstration sequence; one coached sequence; one focused repeat of an unstable transition.

Look for: Candidate flies to the applicable instrument skill standard while giving accurate instruction and correcting scan/control errors before they grow.

Watch / correct: Changing pitch and power repeatedly without waiting for the result -> make a purposeful change, observe and refine.

Watch / correct: Confusing constant rate with constant airspeed -> restate the assigned target and use the appropriate controlling indication.

Stop / transition: End simulated instrument conditions for traffic/lookout failure, control deterioration, disorientation or an aircraft limitation. Maintain a clearly briefed pilot flying and outside observer.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VI.A-E; Instrument Flying Handbook

Teach timed turns and compass-heading errors · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Require the candidate to explain actual compass behavior, heading source limitations and rate/time planning. Use the aircraft indications and current handbook technique; do not invent universal lead/lag values for an unfamiliar instrument.

Student exercise: Teach a timed heading change at the selected authorized turn rate. Compare expected time and actual heading, then explain compass acceleration/turning effects and how a learner can cross-check the result.

Practice: Two timed heading changes in opposite directions; one verbal compass-error case.

Look for: Candidate teaches a valid time/rate method, makes appropriate heading corrections and distinguishes instrument error from control error.

Watch / correct: Starting the clock before establishing turn rate -> establish the rate and define a consistent timing point.

Watch / correct: Chasing compass movement in turbulence -> maintain control and interpret the indication using the appropriate technique.

Stop / transition: Stop for unreliable attitude information, unsafe bank, workload saturation or loss of an outside lookout during simulation; restore the best available safe control method.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VI.F; Instrument Flying Handbook

Teach instrument steep turns · 13 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the candidate brief the applicable instrument task standard and aircraft limitations. Role-play an altitude/scan error only within a safe envelope; assess whether the candidate identifies the cause instead of issuing many unrelated commands.

Student exercise: Clear the area with the observing pilot; demonstrate coordinated instrument steep turns in each direction. Teach the attitude, power and scan changes, then coach the learner through a turn and controlled rollout.

Practice: One demonstrated turn each direction; one coached turn in the weaker direction.

Look for: Candidate maintains the instrument task standard while giving concise teaching and preserving coordination and outside collision protection.

Watch / correct: Bank fixation while altitude diverges -> reconnect the attitude/performance cross-check.

Watch / correct: Abrupt rollout during an explanation -> anticipate the heading and make a smooth transition.

Stop / transition: Discontinue for control deterioration, aircraft limit, traffic or an inadequate outside scan. Safety intervention ends the assessed attempt.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VI.G; Instrument Flying Handbook

Complete a supported approach or visual return · 17 minutes

Teach / coach: Require a current return/approach briefing, aircraft category/equipment, minima if applicable and a missed/landing plan. Observe the candidate's final coaching and protect against fixation on the lesson timer.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches the authorized return, approach or visual pattern, confirms active guidance and approved configuration, makes the landing/missed decision and maintains positive control through rollout.

Practice: One final supported approach/landing or authorized missed/visual alternative; no forced extra approach.

Look for: Actual ATC, approach/visual rules and aircraft limits are respected; teaching stays concise during high workload.

Watch / correct: Trying to finish an explanation below an appropriate workload gate -> fly the approach and discuss later.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or unmet visual conditions -> execute the safe authorized missed/go-around.

Stop / transition: Miss/go around or use the authorized alternative for unstable flight, invalid guidance, unmet required references or runway conflict.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VIII; current charts and aircraft checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E X.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate flies to the applicable instrument skill standard while giving accurate instruction and correcting scan/control errors before they grow.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.

- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- Constant-rate/constant-airspeed tasks and compass cases not completed within the block return in lesson 9 or 11.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor Instrument PTS - source page Tasks VI.A, VI.B, VI.C, VI.D, VI.E, VI.F, VI.G; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-8081-9E, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)

Lesson 3 · Teach unusual attitudes and a lost-indication transition

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90 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Teach instrument checks and taxi clearance	Candidate explains the instrument checks, clearance route and taxi plan; confirms indications/equipment status, briefs hold-short points and stops for any...
08-23 Air 00-15	[] Teach departure and transition to instrument flight	Candidate briefs the cleared departure, flies/teaches the approved takeoff and climb, verifies navigation/modes and transitions to instrument exercise only...
23-48 Air 15-40	[] Teach instrument unusual attitudes and failure recognition	Identify whether indications support a nose-high or nose-low condition, apply the appropriate recovery and reestablish controlled flight.
48-68 Air 40-60	[] Teach approach continuation with lost primary indications	Cross-check reliable sources, stabilize control, select appropriate navigation/approach equipment and teach a supported approach with the remaining indications.
68-85 Air 60-77	[] Complete a supported approach or visual return	Candidate teaches the authorized return, approach or visual pattern, confirms active guidance and approved configuration, makes the landing/missed decision and...
85-90 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 3

Teach recognition before reaction and reliable-instrument control after a clearly announced simulated loss.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Teach recognition before reaction and reliable-instrument control after a clearly announced simulated loss.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Verify baseline scan proficiency, approved failure simulation, reliable backup indications and recovery margin.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Teach recognition before reaction and reliable-instrument control after a clearly announced simulated loss.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach instrument checks and taxi clearance · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach stationary/moving instrument checks using the aircraft checklist and verify the real clearance, navigation source and airport diagram. Act as a learner who overlooks a hold-short or source mismatch only through a verbal cue.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the instrument checks, clearance route and taxi plan; confirms indications/equipment status, briefs hold-short points and stops for any uncertainty before continuing.

Practice: One actual taxi route with each required aircraft instrument check; no head-down programming while moving.

Look for: Checks and clearance/airport route are correctly taught; taxi remains under positive control.

Watch / correct: Head-down setup while moving -> stop in a safe location before programming.

Watch / correct: Check completed without noticing an inconsistent indication -> resolve the indication before dispatch.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for unclear clearance/route, unsafe distraction, abnormal instruments or runway-incursion risk.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E III.C,V.A,X.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach departure and transition to instrument flight · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Confirm who is pilot flying and outside observer; assess the candidate's teaching of actual clearance, departure path, approved speeds/configuration and view-device timing. Prevent a scenario instruction from replacing the real clearance.

Student exercise: Candidate briefs the cleared departure, flies/teaches the approved takeoff and climb, verifies navigation/modes and transitions to instrument exercise only after workload and lookout responsibilities are established.

Practice: One authorized departure/transit; instrument time begins only under actual qualifying conditions.

Look for: Candidate teaches the correct path/configuration and establishes a stable instrument scan without losing clearance or lookout protection.

Watch / correct: Discussing the lesson while missing a clearance restriction -> fly/comply first and shorten instruction.

Watch / correct: Using a view device before a safe observer/control arrangement -> defer device use until responsibilities are clear.

Stop / transition: Discontinue the exercise for an actual clearance conflict, control deterioration, unsafe weather/equipment or lookout failure.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E V.A-B,VI; aircraft departure checklist; 91.109 as applicable

Teach instrument unusual attitudes and failure recognition · 25 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief controlled attitude entry, recovery limits and the available reliable instruments. Let the candidate teach normal-panel recognition before introducing a clearly announced simulated failure; no actual essential system is disabled.

Student exercise: Identify whether indications support a nose-high or nose-low condition, apply the appropriate recovery and reestablish controlled flight. Coach one learner case, explain the reliable-instrument cross-check and identify the common interpretation error.

Practice: One nose-high and one nose-low case; a partial-panel case only after normal-panel proficiency.

Look for: Candidate teaches a prompt, correctly prioritized recovery and detects misleading indications without losing control.

Watch / correct: Assuming one flagged indication represents the true attitude -> cross-check reliable sources.

Watch / correct: Trying to diagnose every cause before recovery -> recover the flight path first and investigate afterward.

Stop / transition: End the simulation for actual equipment malfunction, uncontrolled attitude, aircraft limit or insufficient altitude margin. Restore full visual references when required for safety.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VI.H; Instrument Flying Handbook

Teach approach continuation with lost primary indications · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief exactly which indications are simulated failed and which remain reliable. Use approved simulation methods; never disable an essential system without explicit authority. Require the candidate to teach failure identification and a workload-reduction/diversion plan.

Student exercise: Cross-check reliable sources, stabilize control, select appropriate navigation/approach equipment and teach a supported approach with the remaining indications. Coach a learner transition, request assistance as appropriate and explain why a different approach or landing may be safer.

Practice: One failure-recognition transition and one supported approach segment; complete a full required approach when routing/time permits or carry it forward.

Look for: Candidate identifies the simulated loss, maintains instrument control and gives clear, equipment-applicable instruction through a safe approach decision.

Watch / correct: Continuing to follow a failed display -> identify reliable independent indications and change the scan.

Watch / correct: Choosing an approach unsupported by remaining equipment -> select a supported alternative or discontinue.

Stop / transition: End simulation for actual system failure, loss of reliable attitude/control, unsupported navigation or unsafe workload. Restore the simulated indication or visual references when needed for safety.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E IX.B; Instrument Flying Handbook; aircraft equipment supplements

Complete a supported approach or visual return · 17 minutes

Teach / coach: Require a current return/approach briefing, aircraft category/equipment, minima if applicable and a missed/landing plan. Observe the candidate's final coaching and protect against fixation on the lesson timer.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches the authorized return, approach or visual pattern, confirms active guidance and approved configuration, makes the landing/missed decision and maintains positive control through rollout.

Practice: One final supported approach/landing or authorized missed/visual alternative; no forced extra approach.

Look for: Actual ATC, approach/visual rules and aircraft limits are respected; teaching stays concise during high workload.

Watch / correct: Trying to finish an explanation below an appropriate workload gate -> fly the approach and discuss later.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or unmet visual conditions -> execute the safe authorized missed/go-around.

Stop / transition: Miss/go around or use the authorized alternative for unstable flight, invalid guidance, unmet required references or runway conflict.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VIII; current charts and aircraft checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E X.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate teaches a prompt, correctly prioritized recovery and detects misleading indications without losing control.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- This first partial-panel segment is control practice; a complete partial-panel approach must be demonstrated later.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor Instrument PTS - source page Tasks VI.H, IX.B; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-8081-9E, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)

Procedures and approach instruction

Teach navigation, holding, clearance compliance, approaches and landing/missed decisions.

Lesson 4 · Teach navigation-source selection and tracking

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Teach instrument checks and taxi clearance	Candidate explains the instrument checks, clearance route and taxi plan; confirms indications/equipment status, briefs hold-short points and stops for any...
08-23 Air 00-15	[] Teach departure and transition to instrument flight	Candidate briefs the cleared departure, flies/teaches the approved takeoff and climb, verifies navigation/modes and transitions to instrument exercise only...
23-53 Air 15-45	[] Teach intercepts, tracking and DME-arc principles	Demonstrate intercepting and tracking with the aircraft's authorized ground-based or satellite source.
53-68 Air 45-60	[] Teach IFR clearances and procedure compliance	Explain the clearance limit and applicable departure/en-route/arrival path, verify chart/NOTAM/equipment suitability, set and cross-check the navigation, and...
68-85 Air 60-77	[] Complete a supported approach or visual return	Candidate teaches the authorized return, approach or visual pattern, confirms active guidance and approved configuration, makes the landing/missed decision and...
85-90 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 4

Teach intercepts, tracking and applicable DME-arc principles while preserving clearance and equipment verification.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Teach intercepts, tracking and applicable DME-arc principles while preserving clearance and equipment verification.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Prepare current navigation procedures and confirm which required sources/arc capabilities are installed and available.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Teach intercepts, tracking and applicable DME-arc principles while preserving clearance and equipment verification.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach instrument checks and taxi clearance · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach stationary/moving instrument checks using the aircraft checklist and verify the real clearance, navigation source and airport diagram. Act as a learner who overlooks a hold-short or source mismatch only through a verbal cue.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the instrument checks, clearance route and taxi plan; confirms indications/equipment status, briefs hold-short points and stops for any uncertainty before continuing.

Practice: One actual taxi route with each required aircraft instrument check; no head-down programming while moving.

Look for: Checks and clearance/airport route are correctly taught; taxi remains under positive control.

Watch / correct: Head-down setup while moving -> stop in a safe location before programming.

Watch / correct: Check completed without noticing an inconsistent indication -> resolve the indication before dispatch.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for unclear clearance/route, unsafe distraction, abnormal instruments or runway-incursion risk.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E III.C,V.A,X.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach departure and transition to instrument flight · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Confirm who is pilot flying and outside observer; assess the candidate's teaching of actual clearance, departure path, approved speeds/configuration and view-device timing. Prevent a scenario instruction from replacing the real clearance.

Student exercise: Candidate briefs the cleared departure, flies/teaches the approved takeoff and climb, verifies navigation/modes and transitions to instrument exercise only after workload and lookout responsibilities are established.

Practice: One authorized departure/transit; instrument time begins only under actual qualifying conditions.

Look for: Candidate teaches the correct path/configuration and establishes a stable instrument scan without losing clearance or lookout protection.

Watch / correct: Discussing the lesson while missing a clearance restriction -> fly/comply first and shorten instruction.

Watch / correct: Using a view device before a safe observer/control arrangement -> defer device use until responsibilities are clear.

Stop / transition: Discontinue the exercise for an actual clearance conflict, control deterioration, unsafe weather/equipment or lookout failure.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E V.A-B,VI; aircraft departure checklist; 91.109 as applicable

Teach intercepts, tracking and DME-arc principles · 30 minutes

Teach / coach: Require identification/integrity checks of the selected navigation source and a briefing of the intended intercept/track. Change only a simulated wind or a safe assignment; ask the candidate to diagnose the effect on course tracking.

Student exercise: Demonstrate intercepting and tracking with the aircraft's authorized ground-based or satellite source. Teach wind correction and source/mode verification. When DME-arc practice is applicable and available, explain distance control, lead points and station geometry before coaching a segment.

Practice: One intercept and tracking segment for each available required source; one DME-arc segment if applicable; carry unavailable equipment work to an appropriate aircraft/device.

Look for: Candidate teaches source selection, course/distance control and wind correction while meeting the applicable instrument standard.

Watch / correct: Using the wrong CDI/navigation source -> verify the selected source and active leg before correction.

Watch / correct: Chasing displacement with repeated large heading changes -> use a reasoned intercept and refine the wind correction.

Stop / transition: Discontinue for unreliable/unidentified navigation, unsafe workload or a route conflict. Never invent a procedure or substitute unsupported equipment for a required demonstration.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VII.A; Instrument Flying Handbook; Instrument Procedures Handbook

Teach IFR clearances and procedure compliance · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign a realistic clearance and observe the candidate teach copying, readback, route/altitude interpretation and avionics setup. Act as a learner who accepts an ambiguous instruction; require a clarification request instead of an assumption.

Student exercise: Explain the clearance limit and applicable departure/en-route/arrival path, verify chart/NOTAM/equipment suitability, set and cross-check the navigation, and teach compliance through one amended clearance. Use simulated clearances only when their status is explicitly announced.

Practice: One complete clearance briefing and one amendment; fly the applicable procedure segment when authorized.

Look for: Candidate teaches an accurate clearance interpretation, anticipates the next restriction and seeks clarification before uncertainty changes the flight path.

Watch / correct: Reading back correctly but programming a different route -> compare the clearance, chart and active navigation.

Watch / correct: Assuming a clearance removes a published restriction without justification -> clarify and apply the current rules/procedure.

Stop / transition: No unapproved route/altitude deviation for a training script. Actual ATC instructions and aircraft limitations govern; request an alternative when unable.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E V.A-B; Instrument Procedures Handbook chapters 1-3

Complete a supported approach or visual return · 17 minutes

Teach / coach: Require a current return/approach briefing, aircraft category/equipment, minima if applicable and a missed/landing plan. Observe the candidate's final coaching and protect against fixation on the lesson timer.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches the authorized return, approach or visual pattern, confirms active guidance and approved configuration, makes the landing/missed decision and maintains positive control through rollout.

Practice: One final supported approach/landing or authorized missed/visual alternative; no forced extra approach.

Look for: Actual ATC, approach/visual rules and aircraft limits are respected; teaching stays concise during high workload.

Watch / correct: Trying to finish an explanation below an appropriate workload gate -> fly the approach and discuss later.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or unmet visual conditions -> execute the safe authorized missed/go-around.

Stop / transition: Miss/go around or use the authorized alternative for unstable flight, invalid guidance, unmet required references or runway conflict.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VIII; current charts and aircraft checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E X.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate teaches source selection, course/distance control and wind correction while meeting the applicable instrument standard.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- Required equipment-specific demonstrations unavailable today remain deferred; do not certify them from a verbal description.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor Instrument PTS - source page Tasks VII.A, V.A, V.B; applicable area notes and safety appendices -
FAA-S-8081-9E, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk
instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)

Lesson 5 · Teach holdings, departures and clearance amendments

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Teach instrument checks and taxi clearance	Candidate explains the instrument checks, clearance route and taxi plan; confirms indications/equipment status, briefs hold-short points and stops for any...
08-23 Air 00-15	[] Teach departure and transition to instrument flight	Candidate briefs the cleared departure, flies/teaches the approved takeoff and climb, verifies navigation/modes and transitions to instrument exercise only...
23-51 Air 15-43	[] Teach a hold from clearance to exit	Brief the protected holding geometry and aircraft/procedure limits, enter the hold, establish the outbound correction and adjust the next inbound leg using...
51-68 Air 43-60	[] Teach IFR clearances and procedure compliance	Explain the clearance limit and applicable departure/en-route/arrival path, verify chart/NOTAM/equipment suitability, set and cross-check the navigation, and...
68-85 Air 60-77	[] Complete a supported approach or visual return	Candidate teaches the authorized return, approach or visual pattern, confirms active guidance and approved configuration, makes the landing/missed decision and...
85-90 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 5

Coach holding geometry/wind adjustment and an authorized procedure transition with a changing clearance.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Coach holding geometry/wind adjustment and an authorized procedure transition with a changing clearance.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Prepare a hold, departure/arrival segment, fuel/time plan and actual or simulated clearance roles.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Coach holding geometry/wind adjustment and an authorized procedure transition with a changing clearance.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach instrument checks and taxi clearance · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach stationary/moving instrument checks using the aircraft checklist and verify the real clearance, navigation source and airport diagram. Act as a learner who overlooks a hold-short or source mismatch only through a verbal cue.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the instrument checks, clearance route and taxi plan; confirms indications/equipment status, briefs hold-short points and stops for any uncertainty before continuing.

Practice: One actual taxi route with each required aircraft instrument check; no head-down programming while moving.

Look for: Checks and clearance/airport route are correctly taught; taxi remains under positive control.

Watch / correct: Head-down setup while moving -> stop in a safe location before programming.

Watch / correct: Check completed without noticing an inconsistent indication -> resolve the indication before dispatch.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for unclear clearance/route, unsafe distraction, abnormal instruments or runway-incursion risk.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E III.C,V.A,X.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach departure and transition to instrument flight · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Confirm who is pilot flying and outside observer; assess the candidate's teaching of actual clearance, departure path, approved speeds/configuration and view-device timing. Prevent a scenario instruction from replacing the real clearance.

Student exercise: Candidate briefs the cleared departure, flies/teaches the approved takeoff and climb, verifies navigation/modes and transitions to instrument exercise only after workload and lookout responsibilities are established.

Practice: One authorized departure/transit; instrument time begins only under actual qualifying conditions.

Look for: Candidate teaches the correct path/configuration and establishes a stable instrument scan without losing clearance or lookout protection.

Watch / correct: Discussing the lesson while missing a clearance restriction -> fly/comply first and shorten instruction.

Watch / correct: Using a view device before a safe observer/control arrangement -> defer device use until responsibilities are clear.

Stop / transition: Discontinue the exercise for an actual clearance conflict, control deterioration, unsafe weather/equipment or lookout failure.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E V.A-B,VI; aircraft departure checklist; 91.109 as applicable

Teach a hold from clearance to exit · 28 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign a complete hold clearance and ask the candidate to teach fix, direction, turns, leg limit, altitude, entry, speed and expected clearance time. Act as a learner who reverses the inbound course or overlooks a restriction.

Student exercise: Brief the protected holding geometry and aircraft/procedure limits, enter the hold, establish the outbound correction and adjust the next inbound leg using observed wind. Coach a second circuit and teach an orderly clearance-compliant exit.

Practice: One candidate-led entry and circuit; one coached circuit; one exit/amendment discussion.

Look for: Candidate teaches a valid entry/holding plan, respects limits and manages wind corrections and clearance status without losing aircraft control.

Watch / correct: Selecting an entry without understanding the inbound leg -> draw/brief the geometry before crossing the fix.

Watch / correct: Programming the hold but failing to verify turn direction or leg limit -> compare the active hold with the clearance.

Stop / transition: Do not exceed clearance/procedure protection to finish a demonstration. Exit or request amended clearance if equipment, weather, fuel or workload makes the hold unsuitable.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VII.B; Instrument Procedures Handbook chapter 2

Teach IFR clearances and procedure compliance · 17 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign a realistic clearance and observe the candidate teach copying, readback, route/altitude interpretation and avionics setup. Act as a learner who accepts an ambiguous instruction; require a clarification request instead of an assumption.

Student exercise: Explain the clearance limit and applicable departure/en-route/arrival path, verify chart/NOTAM/equipment suitability, set and cross-check the navigation, and teach compliance through one

amended clearance. Use simulated clearances only when their status is explicitly announced.

Practice: One complete clearance briefing and one amendment; fly the applicable procedure segment when authorized.

Look for: Candidate teaches an accurate clearance interpretation, anticipates the next restriction and seeks clarification before uncertainty changes the flight path.

Watch / correct: Reading back correctly but programming a different route -> compare the clearance, chart and active navigation.

Watch / correct: Assuming a clearance removes a published restriction without justification -> clarify and apply the current rules/procedure.

Stop / transition: No unapproved route/altitude deviation for a training script. Actual ATC instructions and aircraft limitations govern; request an alternative when unable.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E V.A-B; Instrument Procedures Handbook chapters 1-3

Complete a supported approach or visual return · 17 minutes

Teach / coach: Require a current return/approach briefing, aircraft category/equipment, minima if applicable and a missed/landing plan. Observe the candidate's final coaching and protect against fixation on the lesson timer.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches the authorized return, approach or visual pattern, confirms active guidance and approved configuration, makes the landing/missed decision and maintains positive control through rollout.

Practice: One final supported approach/landing or authorized missed/visual alternative; no forced extra approach.

Look for: Actual ATC, approach/visual rules and aircraft limits are respected; teaching stays concise during high workload.

Watch / correct: Trying to finish an explanation below an appropriate workload gate -> fly the approach and discuss later.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or unmet visual conditions -> execute the safe authorized missed/go-around.

Stop / transition: Miss/go around or use the authorized alternative for unstable flight, invalid guidance, unmet required references or runway conflict.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VIII; current charts and aircraft checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E X.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate teaches a valid entry/holding plan, respects limits and manages wind corrections and clearance status without losing aircraft control.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- An unavailable procedure/hold entry is assigned to integrated IFR review with the correct equipment and authorization.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor Instrument PTS - source page Tasks VII.B, V.A, V.B; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-8081-9E, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)

Lesson 6 · Teach nonprecision approach planning

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Teach instrument checks and taxi clearance	Candidate explains the instrument checks, clearance route and taxi plan; confirms indications/equipment status, briefs hold-short points and stops for any...
08-23 Air 00-15	[] Teach departure and transition to instrument flight	Candidate briefs the cleared departure, flies/teaches the approved takeoff and climb, verifies navigation/modes and transitions to instrument exercise only...
23-53 Air 15-45	[] Teach a nonprecision approach and descent planning	Verify source/mode and active procedure, fly the cleared approach, teach the applicable minimum altitude and descent method, and monitor the lateral/vertical...
53-68 Air 45-60	[] Teach a missed approach as an immediate aircraft-control task	Initiate the approved climb/configuration transition, follow the authorized missed path and communicate appropriately.
68-85 Air 60-77	[] Complete a supported approach or visual return	Candidate teaches the authorized return, approach or visual pattern, confirms active guidance and approved configuration, makes the landing/missed decision and...
85-90 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 6

Teach the full approach briefing, supported descent path and a timely missed decision.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Teach the full approach briefing, supported descent path and a timely missed decision.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Use current charts/NOTAMs; verify approach category, equipment, minima and aircraft performance.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Teach the full approach briefing, supported descent path and a timely missed decision.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach instrument checks and taxi clearance · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach stationary/moving instrument checks using the aircraft checklist and verify the real clearance, navigation source and airport diagram. Act as a learner who overlooks a hold-short or source mismatch only through a verbal cue.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the instrument checks, clearance route and taxi plan; confirms indications/equipment status, briefs hold-short points and stops for any uncertainty before continuing.

Practice: One actual taxi route with each required aircraft instrument check; no head-down programming while moving.

Look for: Checks and clearance/airport route are correctly taught; taxi remains under positive control.

Watch / correct: Head-down setup while moving -> stop in a safe location before programming.

Watch / correct: Check completed without noticing an inconsistent indication -> resolve the indication before dispatch.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for unclear clearance/route, unsafe distraction, abnormal instruments or runway-incursion risk.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E III.C,V.A,X.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach departure and transition to instrument flight · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Confirm who is pilot flying and outside observer; assess the candidate's teaching of actual clearance, departure path, approved speeds/configuration and view-device timing. Prevent a scenario instruction from replacing the real clearance.

Student exercise: Candidate briefs the cleared departure, flies/teaches the approved takeoff and climb, verifies navigation/modes and transitions to instrument exercise only after workload and lookout responsibilities are established.

Practice: One authorized departure/transit; instrument time begins only under actual qualifying conditions.

Look for: Candidate teaches the correct path/configuration and establishes a stable instrument scan without losing clearance or lookout protection.

Watch / correct: Discussing the lesson while missing a clearance restriction -> fly/comply first and shorten instruction.

Watch / correct: Using a view device before a safe observer/control arrangement -> defer device use until responsibilities are clear.

Stop / transition: Discontinue the exercise for an actual clearance conflict, control deterioration, unsafe weather/equipment or lookout failure.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E V.A-B,VI; aircraft departure checklist; 91.109 as applicable

Teach a nonprecision approach and descent planning · 30 minutes

Teach / coach: Require a full approach briefing using current charts/NOTAMs, aircraft category, equipment and minima. Observe the candidate teach course/altitude restrictions, descent planning, missed approach and the required visual transition. Role-play one misidentified waypoint verbally.

Student exercise: Verify source/mode and active procedure, fly the cleared approach, teach the applicable minimum altitude and descent method, and monitor the lateral/vertical path. At the decision point, teach the appropriate missed approach or a legal visual transition.

Practice: One demonstration and one coached approach if routing permits; otherwise one approach with a detailed diagnosis and carry-forward.

Look for: Candidate teaches a current, properly briefed procedure, respects every applicable restriction and makes a timely, lawful missed/landing decision.

Watch / correct: Using a displayed advisory glidepath as permission below a minimum -> explain its status and respect the published/regulatory limits.

Watch / correct: Delaying the missed approach while searching for references -> act at the briefed decision point.

Stop / transition: Miss or discontinue for an unstable approach, wrong source/leg, prohibited descent, loss of required guidance or an unmet visual requirement. Published procedures and actual ATC govern.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VIII.A; Instrument Procedures Handbook chapter 4

Teach a missed approach as an immediate aircraft-control task · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Prebrief the aircraft transition, climb capability, initial path, sequencing and actual ATC instructions. Assign a missed approach at the briefed point; assess whether the candidate manages flight control before lengthy explanation or programming.

Student exercise: Initiate the approved climb/configuration transition, follow the authorized missed path and communicate appropriately. Teach the learner how to confirm navigation sequencing while maintaining control and obstacle clearance, then accept the next clearance only when ready.

Practice: One candidate-led missed approach and one coached missed/transition, subject to ATC and traffic.

Look for: Candidate teaches and executes a prompt, controlled transition with correct path, configuration and communications.

Watch / correct: Programming before establishing the climb -> fly the transition first, then verify navigation.

Watch / correct: Turning before the procedure permits -> remain on the authorized path and verify the missed instructions.

Stop / transition: Actual clearance, aircraft performance and obstacle protection govern. Stop the training script for a climb-performance threat, mode uncertainty or excessive workload and use the safest authorized alternative.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VIII.C; Instrument Procedures Handbook chapter 4

Complete a supported approach or visual return · 17 minutes

Teach / coach: Require a current return/approach briefing, aircraft category/equipment, minima if applicable and a missed/landing plan. Observe the candidate's final coaching and protect against fixation on the lesson timer.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches the authorized return, approach or visual pattern, confirms active guidance and approved configuration, makes the landing/missed decision and maintains positive control through rollout.

Practice: One final supported approach/landing or authorized missed/visual alternative; no forced extra approach.

Look for: Actual ATC, approach/visual rules and aircraft limits are respected; teaching stays concise during high workload.

Watch / correct: Trying to finish an explanation below an appropriate workload gate -> fly the approach and discuss later.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or unmet visual conditions -> execute the safe authorized missed/go-around.

Stop / transition: Miss/go around or use the authorized alternative for unstable flight, invalid guidance, unmet required references or runway conflict.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VIII; current charts and aircraft checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E X.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate teaches a current, properly briefed procedure, respects every applicable restriction and makes a timely, lawful missed/landing decision.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- If routing permits only one approach, carry the coached second attempt forward rather than shorten the approach briefing or miss.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor Instrument PTS - source page Tasks VIII.A, VIII.C; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-8081-9E, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)

Lesson 7 · Teach precision guidance and mode awareness

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Teach instrument checks and taxi clearance	Candidate explains the instrument checks, clearance route and taxi plan; confirms indications/equipment status, briefs hold-short points and stops for any...
08-23 Air 00-15	[] Teach departure and transition to instrument flight	Candidate briefs the cleared departure, flies/teaches the approved takeoff and climb, verifies navigation/modes and transitions to instrument exercise only...
23-53 Air 15-45	[] Teach precision/vertical-guidance approach management	Demonstrate source/mode verification, interception and tracking of the required lateral/vertical guidance.
53-68 Air 45-60	[] Teach a missed approach as an immediate aircraft-control task	Initiate the approved climb/configuration transition, follow the authorized missed path and communicate appropriately.
68-85 Air 60-77	[] Complete a supported approach or visual return	Candidate teaches the authorized return, approach or visual pattern, confirms active guidance and approved configuration, makes the landing/missed decision and...
85-90 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 7

Coach interception, mode verification and stabilized vertical-path control without treating all GPS guidance as equivalent.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Coach interception, mode verification and stabilized vertical-path control without treating all GPS guidance as equivalent.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Verify the exact approach type required for the PTS task and the aircraft equipment/approval needed to fly it.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Coach interception, mode verification and stabilized vertical-path control without treating all GPS guidance as equivalent.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach instrument checks and taxi clearance · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach stationary/moving instrument checks using the aircraft checklist and verify the real clearance, navigation source and airport diagram. Act as a learner who overlooks a hold-short or source mismatch only through a verbal cue.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the instrument checks, clearance route and taxi plan; confirms indications/equipment status, briefs hold-short points and stops for any uncertainty before continuing.

Practice: One actual taxi route with each required aircraft instrument check; no head-down programming while moving.

Look for: Checks and clearance/airport route are correctly taught; taxi remains under positive control.

Watch / correct: Head-down setup while moving -> stop in a safe location before programming.

Watch / correct: Check completed without noticing an inconsistent indication -> resolve the indication before dispatch.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for unclear clearance/route, unsafe distraction, abnormal instruments or runway-incursion risk.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E III.C,V.A,X.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach departure and transition to instrument flight · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Confirm who is pilot flying and outside observer; assess the candidate's teaching of actual clearance, departure path, approved speeds/configuration and view-device timing. Prevent a scenario instruction from replacing the real clearance.

Student exercise: Candidate briefs the cleared departure, flies/teaches the approved takeoff and climb, verifies navigation/modes and transitions to instrument exercise only after workload and lookout responsibilities are established.

Practice: One authorized departure/transit; instrument time begins only under actual qualifying conditions.

Look for: Candidate teaches the correct path/configuration and establishes a stable instrument scan without losing clearance or lookout protection.

Watch / correct: Discussing the lesson while missing a clearance restriction -> fly/comply first and shorten instruction.

Watch / correct: Using a view device before a safe observer/control arrangement -> defer device use until responsibilities are clear.

Stop / transition: Discontinue the exercise for an actual clearance conflict, control deterioration, unsafe weather/equipment or lookout failure.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E V.A-B,VI; aircraft departure checklist; 91.109 as applicable

Teach precision/vertical-guidance approach management · 30 minutes

Teach / coach: Require the candidate to identify the exact approach type and available guidance; do not label every GPS vertical path a precision approach. Brief mode capture, minima, missed procedure and required equipment.

Student exercise: Demonstrate source/mode verification, interception and tracking of the required lateral/vertical guidance. Coach the learner through configuration, stabilized descent and the approach decision, while explaining the indicated trend rather than issuing disconnected corrections.

Practice: One demonstration and one coached approach when available; verify the actual PTS-required approach equipment/type before claiming task coverage.

Look for: Candidate teaches the applicable approach accurately, maintains task limits and chooses missed approach or legal landing at the correct point.

Watch / correct: Assuming the armed mode is active guidance -> confirm capture/annunciation and actual course response.

Watch / correct: Treating LPV, LNAV/VNAV and ILS as interchangeable -> identify the procedure type and applicable task requirements.

Stop / transition: Miss for guidance failure, an unstable path, unmet visual conditions or an aircraft/procedure restriction. Never descend on an invalid or unverified vertical path.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VIII.B; Instrument Procedures Handbook chapter 4

Teach a missed approach as an immediate aircraft-control task · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Prebrief the aircraft transition, climb capability, initial path, sequencing and actual ATC instructions. Assign a missed approach at the briefed point; assess whether the candidate manages flight control before lengthy explanation or programming.

Student exercise: Initiate the approved climb/configuration transition, follow the authorized missed path and communicate appropriately. Teach the learner how to confirm navigation sequencing while maintaining control and obstacle clearance, then accept the next clearance only when ready.

Practice: One candidate-led missed approach and one coached missed/transition, subject to ATC and traffic.

Look for: Candidate teaches and executes a prompt, controlled transition with correct path, configuration and communications.

Watch / correct: Programming before establishing the climb -> fly the transition first, then verify navigation.

Watch / correct: Turning before the procedure permits -> remain on the authorized path and verify the missed instructions.

Stop / transition: Actual clearance, aircraft performance and obstacle protection govern. Stop the training script for a climb-performance threat, mode uncertainty or excessive workload and use the safest authorized alternative.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VIII.C; Instrument Procedures Handbook chapter 4

Complete a supported approach or visual return · 17 minutes

Teach / coach: Require a current return/approach briefing, aircraft category/equipment, minima if applicable and a missed/landing plan. Observe the candidate's final coaching and protect against fixation on the lesson timer.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches the authorized return, approach or visual pattern, confirms active guidance and approved configuration, makes the landing/missed decision and maintains positive control through rollout.

Practice: One final supported approach/landing or authorized missed/visual alternative; no forced extra approach.

Look for: Actual ATC, approach/visual rules and aircraft limits are respected; teaching stays concise during high workload.

Watch / correct: Trying to finish an explanation below an appropriate workload gate -> fly the approach and discuss later.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or unmet visual conditions -> execute the safe authorized missed/go-around.

Stop / transition: Miss/go around or use the authorized alternative for unstable flight, invalid guidance, unmet required references or runway conflict.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VIII; current charts and aircraft checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E X.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate teaches the applicable approach accurately, maintains task limits and chooses missed approach or legal landing at the correct point.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- If only advisory or nonprecision guidance is available, the precision task remains uncompleted until suitable facilities/equipment are used.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor Instrument PTS - source page Tasks VIII.B, VIII.C; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-8081-9E, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)

Lesson 8 · Teach circling, visual transitions and missed decisions

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Teach instrument checks and taxi clearance	Candidate explains the instrument checks, clearance route and taxi plan; confirms indications/equipment status, briefs hold-short points and stops for any...
08-23 Air 00-15	[] Teach departure and transition to instrument flight	Candidate briefs the cleared departure, flies/teaches the approved takeoff and climb, verifies navigation/modes and transitions to instrument exercise only...
23-53 Air 15-45	[] Teach circling and the straight-in visual transition	Teach the authorized visual maneuver within the applicable protected area and limits, maintaining required references and a stable landing path.
53-68 Air 45-60	[] Teach a missed approach as an immediate aircraft-control task	Initiate the approved climb/configuration transition, follow the authorized missed path and communicate appropriately.
68-85 Air 60-77	[] Complete a supported approach or visual return	Candidate teaches the authorized return, approach or visual pattern, confirms active guidance and approved configuration, makes the landing/missed decision and...
85-90 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 8

Manage the protected-area, visual-reference and landing-energy risks while teaching the decision to continue or miss.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Manage the protected-area, visual-reference and landing-energy risks while teaching the decision to continue or miss.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Prepare circling category/area/minima and prohibited-sector notes, visual-transition conditions and missed procedures.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Manage the protected-area, visual-reference and landing-energy risks while teaching the decision to continue or miss.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach instrument checks and taxi clearance · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach stationary/moving instrument checks using the aircraft checklist and verify the real clearance, navigation source and airport diagram. Act as a learner who overlooks a hold-short or source mismatch only through a verbal cue.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the instrument checks, clearance route and taxi plan; confirms indications/equipment status, briefs hold-short points and stops for any uncertainty before continuing.

Practice: One actual taxi route with each required aircraft instrument check; no head-down programming while moving.

Look for: Checks and clearance/airport route are correctly taught; taxi remains under positive control.

Watch / correct: Head-down setup while moving -> stop in a safe location before programming.

Watch / correct: Check completed without noticing an inconsistent indication -> resolve the indication before dispatch.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for unclear clearance/route, unsafe distraction, abnormal instruments or runway-incursion risk.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E III.C,V.A,X.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach departure and transition to instrument flight · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Confirm who is pilot flying and outside observer; assess the candidate's teaching of actual clearance, departure path, approved speeds/configuration and view-device timing. Prevent a scenario instruction from replacing the real clearance.

Student exercise: Candidate briefs the cleared departure, flies/teaches the approved takeoff and climb, verifies navigation/modes and transitions to instrument exercise only after workload and lookout responsibilities are established.

Practice: One authorized departure/transit; instrument time begins only under actual qualifying conditions.

Look for: Candidate teaches the correct path/configuration and establishes a stable instrument scan without losing clearance or lookout protection.

Watch / correct: Discussing the lesson while missing a clearance restriction -> fly/comply first and shorten instruction.

Watch / correct: Using a view device before a safe observer/control arrangement -> defer device use until responsibilities are clear.

Stop / transition: Discontinue the exercise for an actual clearance conflict, control deterioration, unsafe weather/equipment or lookout failure.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E V.A-B,VI; aircraft departure checklist; 91.109 as applicable

Teach circling and the straight-in visual transition · 30 minutes

Teach / coach: Require a current circling-area/minima briefing, aircraft category, prohibited sectors and a visual-reference/missed plan. For straight-in landing, ask the candidate to teach the difference between acquiring references and being able to land normally.

Student exercise: Teach the authorized visual maneuver within the applicable protected area and limits, maintaining required references and a stable landing path. Coach the straight-in transition or circle as assigned. Discuss loss of visual references and execute the applicable missed action if needed.

Practice: One circling scenario when authorized/safe, plus one straight-in transition; a verbal circle does not satisfy a required flight demonstration.

Look for: Candidate maintains protected-area/altitude limits, teaches a continuous visual and energy scan, and chooses a safe missed approach promptly.

Watch / correct: Reducing altitude before a normal descent/landing is possible -> maintain the applicable minimum until legal conditions exist.

Watch / correct: Circling too tightly to force runway alignment -> choose a safe path or missed approach.

Stop / transition: Miss or discontinue for loss of required visual references, protected-area uncertainty, an unstable landing path or prohibited circling conditions. No universal circling radius is supplied.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VIII.D-E; Instrument Procedures Handbook chapter 4

Teach a missed approach as an immediate aircraft-control task · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Prebrief the aircraft transition, climb capability, initial path, sequencing and actual ATC instructions. Assign a missed approach at the briefed point; assess whether the candidate manages flight control before lengthy explanation or programming.

Student exercise: Initiate the approved climb/configuration transition, follow the authorized missed path and communicate appropriately. Teach the learner how to confirm navigation sequencing while maintaining control and obstacle clearance, then accept the next clearance only when ready.

Practice: One candidate-led missed approach and one coached missed/transition, subject to ATC and traffic.

Look for: Candidate teaches and executes a prompt, controlled transition with correct path, configuration and communications.

Watch / correct: Programming before establishing the climb -> fly the transition first, then verify navigation.

Watch / correct: Turning before the procedure permits -> remain on the authorized path and verify the missed instructions.

Stop / transition: Actual clearance, aircraft performance and obstacle protection govern. Stop the training script for a climb-performance threat, mode uncertainty or excessive workload and use the safest authorized alternative.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VIII.C; Instrument Procedures Handbook chapter 4

Complete a supported approach or visual return · 17 minutes

Teach / coach: Require a current return/approach briefing, aircraft category/equipment, minima if applicable and a missed/landing plan. Observe the candidate's final coaching and protect against fixation on the lesson timer.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches the authorized return, approach or visual pattern, confirms active guidance and approved configuration, makes the landing/missed decision and maintains positive control through rollout.

Practice: One final supported approach/landing or authorized missed/visual alternative; no forced extra approach.

Look for: Actual ATC, approach/visual rules and aircraft limits are respected; teaching stays concise during high workload.

Watch / correct: Trying to finish an explanation below an appropriate workload gate -> fly the approach and discuss later.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or unmet visual conditions -> execute the safe authorized missed/go-around.

Stop / transition: Miss/go around or use the authorized alternative for unstable flight, invalid guidance, unmet required references or runway conflict.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VIII; current charts and aircraft checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E X.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate maintains protected-area/altitude limits, teaches a continuous visual and energy scan, and chooses a safe missed approach promptly.

Debrief - 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- Do not force a circling demonstration in unsuitable weather/traffic; defer the required flight task to a safe opportunity.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor Instrument PTS - source page Tasks VIII.D, VIII.E, VIII.C; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-8081-9E, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)

Integration and instructor assessment

Teach integrated scenarios, IPC planning and the applicable initial/additional CFII standard; multiengine work is conditional.

Lesson 9 · Lead an IFR instructional mission with abnormalities

[Return to lesson index](#)

120 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Teach instrument checks and taxi clearance	Candidate explains the instrument checks, clearance route and taxi plan; confirms indications/equipment status, briefs hold-short points and stops for any...
08-25 Air 00-17	[] Teach departure and transition to instrument flight	Candidate briefs the cleared departure, flies/teaches the approved takeoff and climb, verifies navigation/modes and transitions to instrument exercise only...
25-40 Air 17-32	[] Teach IFR clearances and procedure compliance	Explain the clearance limit and applicable departure/en-route/arrival path, verify chart/NOTAM/equipment suitability, set and cross-check the navigation, and...
40-55 Air 32-47	[] Teach a hold from clearance to exit	Brief the protected holding geometry and aircraft/procedure limits, enter the hold, establish the outbound correction and adjust the next inbound leg using...
55-80 Air 47-72	[] Teach approach continuation with lost primary indications	Cross-check reliable sources, stabilize control, select appropriate navigation/approach equipment and teach a supported approach with the remaining indications.
80-95 Air 72-87	[] Teach a loss-of-communications decision without guessing clearance	Maintain aircraft control; verify the simulated failure; identify available communication alternatives; explain and apply the appropriate rule/procedure to the...
95-115 Air 87-107	[] Complete a supported approach or visual return	Candidate teaches the authorized return, approach or visual pattern, confirms active guidance and approved configuration, makes the landing/missed decision and...
115-120 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 9

Integrate a clearance change, hold and supported partial-panel approach; discuss lost communications without violating the actual clearance.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Integrate a clearance change, hold and supported partial-panel approach; discuss lost communications without violating the actual clearance.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Prepare an authorized IFR/simulated-IFR mission, backup approach, fuel/diversion plan and approved failure simulation.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Integrate a clearance change, hold and supported partial-panel approach; discuss lost communications without violating the actual clearance.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach instrument checks and taxi clearance · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach stationary/moving instrument checks using the aircraft checklist and verify the real clearance, navigation source and airport diagram. Act as a learner who overlooks a hold-short or source mismatch only through a verbal cue.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the instrument checks, clearance route and taxi plan; confirms indications/equipment status, briefs hold-short points and stops for any uncertainty before continuing.

Practice: One actual taxi route with each required aircraft instrument check; no head-down programming while moving.

Look for: Checks and clearance/airport route are correctly taught; taxi remains under positive control.

Watch / correct: Head-down setup while moving -> stop in a safe location before programming.

Watch / correct: Check completed without noticing an inconsistent indication -> resolve the indication before dispatch.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for unclear clearance/route, unsafe distraction, abnormal instruments or runway-incursion risk.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E III.C,V.A,X.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach departure and transition to instrument flight · 17 minutes

Teach / coach: Confirm who is pilot flying and outside observer; assess the candidate's teaching of actual clearance, departure path, approved speeds/configuration and view-device timing. Prevent a scenario instruction from replacing the real clearance.

Student exercise: Candidate briefs the cleared departure, flies/teaches the approved takeoff and climb, verifies navigation/modes and transitions to instrument exercise only after workload and lookout responsibilities are established.

Practice: One authorized departure/transit; instrument time begins only under actual qualifying conditions.

Look for: Candidate teaches the correct path/configuration and establishes a stable instrument scan without losing clearance or lookout protection.

Watch / correct: Discussing the lesson while missing a clearance restriction -> fly/comply first and shorten instruction.

Watch / correct: Using a view device before a safe observer/control arrangement -> defer device use until responsibilities are clear.

Stop / transition: Discontinue the exercise for an actual clearance conflict, control deterioration, unsafe weather/equipment or lookout failure.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E V.A-B,VI; aircraft departure checklist; 91.109 as applicable

Teach IFR clearances and procedure compliance · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign a realistic clearance and observe the candidate teach copying, readback, route/altitude interpretation and avionics setup. Act as a learner who accepts an ambiguous instruction; require a clarification request instead of an assumption.

Student exercise: Explain the clearance limit and applicable departure/en-route/arrival path, verify chart/NOTAM/equipment suitability, set and cross-check the navigation, and teach compliance through one amended clearance. Use simulated clearances only when their status is explicitly announced.

Practice: One complete clearance briefing and one amendment; fly the applicable procedure segment when authorized.

Look for: Candidate teaches an accurate clearance interpretation, anticipates the next restriction and seeks clarification before uncertainty changes the flight path.

Watch / correct: Reading back correctly but programming a different route -> compare the clearance, chart and active navigation.

Watch / correct: Assuming a clearance removes a published restriction without justification -> clarify and apply the current rules/procedure.

Stop / transition: No unapproved route/altitude deviation for a training script. Actual ATC instructions and aircraft limitations govern; request an alternative when unable.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E V.A-B; Instrument Procedures Handbook chapters 1-3

Teach a hold from clearance to exit · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign a complete hold clearance and ask the candidate to teach fix, direction, turns, leg limit, altitude, entry, speed and expected clearance time. Act as a learner who reverses the inbound course or overlooks a restriction.

Student exercise: Brief the protected holding geometry and aircraft/procedure limits, enter the hold, establish the outbound correction and adjust the next inbound leg using observed wind. Coach a second circuit and teach an orderly clearance-compliant exit.

Practice: One candidate-led entry and circuit; one coached circuit; one exit/amendment discussion.

Look for: Candidate teaches a valid entry/holding plan, respects limits and manages wind corrections and clearance status without losing aircraft control.

Watch / correct: Selecting an entry without understanding the inbound leg -> draw/brief the geometry before crossing the fix.

Watch / correct: Programming the hold but failing to verify turn direction or leg limit -> compare the active hold with the clearance.

Stop / transition: Do not exceed clearance/procedure protection to finish a demonstration. Exit or request amended clearance if equipment, weather, fuel or workload makes the hold unsuitable.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VII.B; Instrument Procedures Handbook chapter 2

Teach approach continuation with lost primary indications · 25 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief exactly which indications are simulated failed and which remain reliable. Use approved simulation methods; never disable an essential system without explicit authority. Require the candidate to teach failure identification and a workload-reduction/diversion plan.

Student exercise: Cross-check reliable sources, stabilize control, select appropriate navigation/approach equipment and teach a supported approach with the remaining indications. Coach a learner transition, request assistance as appropriate and explain why a different approach or landing may be safer.

Practice: One failure-recognition transition and one supported approach segment; complete a full required approach when routing/time permits or carry it forward.

Look for: Candidate identifies the simulated loss, maintains instrument control and gives clear, equipment-applicable instruction through a safe approach decision.

Watch / correct: Continuing to follow a failed display -> identify reliable independent indications and change the scan.

Watch / correct: Choosing an approach unsupported by remaining equipment -> select a supported alternative or discontinue.

Stop / transition: End simulation for actual system failure, loss of reliable attitude/control, unsupported navigation or unsafe workload. Restore the simulated indication or visual references when needed for safety.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E IX.B; Instrument Flying Handbook; aircraft equipment supplements

Teach a loss-of-communications decision without guessing clearance · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Use a prebriefed scenario card and clearly distinguish simulated silence from a real radio failure. Ask the candidate to teach VMC/IMC decision differences, troubleshooting, route/altitude and clearance-limit reasoning using current references.

Student exercise: Maintain aircraft control; verify the simulated failure; identify available communication alternatives; explain and apply the appropriate rule/procedure to the scenario. Teach how current weather,

fuel and landing options affect the decision.

Practice: One VMC and one IMC verbal scenario while following the actual authorized flight path; do not intentionally stop complying with ATC.

Look for: Candidate gives a regulation-supported route/altitude/landing plan, maintains flight control and does not confuse a scenario clearance with the real clearance.

Watch / correct: Reciting a mnemonic without resolving the clearance limit -> work through the actual clearance and rule.

Watch / correct: Changing route during a pretend radio failure -> keep actual ATC compliance while discussing the simulated decision.

Stop / transition: Actual communications failure or clearance uncertainty ends role-play. Apply current rules and available assistance; do not deviate merely to enact a scenario.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E IX.A; current 14 CFR 91.185 and AIM

Complete a supported approach or visual return · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Require a current return/approach briefing, aircraft category/equipment, minima if applicable and a missed/landing plan. Observe the candidate's final coaching and protect against fixation on the lesson timer.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches the authorized return, approach or visual pattern, confirms active guidance and approved configuration, makes the landing/missed decision and maintains positive control through rollout.

Practice: One final supported approach/landing or authorized missed/visual alternative; no forced extra approach.

Look for: Actual ATC, approach/visual rules and aircraft limits are respected; teaching stays concise during high workload.

Watch / correct: Trying to finish an explanation below an appropriate workload gate -> fly the approach and discuss later.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or unmet visual conditions -> execute the safe authorized missed/go-around.

Stop / transition: Miss/go around or use the authorized alternative for unstable flight, invalid guidance, unmet required references or runway conflict.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VIII; current charts and aircraft checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E X.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate teaches an accurate clearance interpretation, anticipates the next restriction and seeks clarification before uncertainty changes the flight path.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- If a complete required partial-panel approach cannot be flown, record it as deferred and plan a dedicated follow-up.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor Instrument PTS - source page Tasks V.A, V.B, VII.B, IX.B, IX.A; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-8081-9E, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)

Lesson 10 · Plan an IPC and teach selected proficiency segments

[Return to lesson index](#)

120 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Teach instrument checks and taxi clearance	Candidate explains the instrument checks, clearance route and taxi plan; confirms indications/equipment status, briefs hold-short points and stops for any...
08-25 Air 00-17	[] Teach departure and transition to instrument flight	Candidate briefs the cleared departure, flies/teaches the approved takeoff and climb, verifies navigation/modes and transitions to instrument exercise only...
25-40 Air 17-32	[] Teach basic instrument control and changes of airspeed	Teach level flight and turns, then change airspeed while preserving the path.
40-55 Air 32-47	[] Teach intercepts, tracking and DME-arc principles	Demonstrate intercepting and tracking with the aircraft's authorized ground-based or satellite source.
55-75 Air 47-67	[] Teach a nonprecision approach and descent planning	Verify source/mode and active procedure, fly the cleared approach, teach the applicable minimum altitude and descent method, and monitor the lateral/vertical...
75-95 Air 67-87	[] Teach precision/vertical-guidance approach management	Demonstrate source/mode verification, interception and tracking of the required lateral/vertical guidance.
95-115 Air 87-107	[] Complete a supported approach or visual return	Candidate teaches the authorized return, approach or visual pattern, confirms active guidance and approved configuration, makes the landing/missed decision and...
115-120 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 10

Build a pilot-specific IPC plan from current requirements, then teach selected instrument-control/navigation/approach segments and identify every remaining required observation.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Build a pilot-specific IPC plan from current requirements, then teach selected instrument-control/navigation/approach segments and identify every remaining required observation.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Review 61.57(d), current Instrument Rating ACS IPC table and aircraft/device credit limits; interview the role-play pilot about recency and operation.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Build a pilot-specific IPC plan from current requirements, then teach selected instrument-control/navigation/approach segments and identify every remaining required observation.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach instrument checks and taxi clearance · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach stationary/moving instrument checks using the aircraft checklist and verify the real clearance, navigation source and airport diagram. Act as a learner who overlooks a hold-short or source mismatch only through a verbal cue.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the instrument checks, clearance route and taxi plan; confirms indications/equipment status, briefs hold-short points and stops for any uncertainty before continuing.

Practice: One actual taxi route with each required aircraft instrument check; no head-down programming while moving.

Look for: Checks and clearance/airport route are correctly taught; taxi remains under positive control.

Watch / correct: Head-down setup while moving -> stop in a safe location before programming.

Watch / correct: Check completed without noticing an inconsistent indication -> resolve the indication before dispatch.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for unclear clearance/route, unsafe distraction, abnormal instruments or runway-incursion risk.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E III.C,V.A,X.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach departure and transition to instrument flight · 17 minutes

Teach / coach: Confirm who is pilot flying and outside observer; assess the candidate's teaching of actual clearance, departure path, approved speeds/configuration and view-device timing. Prevent a scenario instruction from replacing the real clearance.

Student exercise: Candidate briefs the cleared departure, flies/teaches the approved takeoff and climb, verifies navigation/modes and transitions to instrument exercise only after workload and lookout responsibilities are established.

Practice: One authorized departure/transit; instrument time begins only under actual qualifying conditions.

Look for: Candidate teaches the correct path/configuration and establishes a stable instrument scan without losing clearance or lookout protection.

Watch / correct: Discussing the lesson while missing a clearance restriction -> fly/comply first and shorten instruction.

Watch / correct: Using a view device before a safe observer/control arrangement -> defer device use until responsibilities are clear.

Stop / transition: Discontinue the exercise for an actual clearance conflict, control deterioration, unsafe weather/equipment or lookout failure.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E V.A-B,VI; aircraft departure checklist; 91.109 as applicable

Teach basic instrument control and changes of airspeed · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Ask the candidate to teach control/performance or primary/supporting technique using the actual instrument presentation. Act as a learner who overcontrols a small error; require concise feedback that reconnects attitude/power with the desired flight path.

Student exercise: Teach level flight and turns, then change airspeed while preserving the path. Demonstrate constant-airspeed and constant-rate climbs/descents, explaining which parameter is controlled and which instrument trend verifies it. Coach an integrated learner sequence.

Practice: One candidate demonstration sequence; one coached sequence; one focused repeat of an unstable transition.

Look for: Candidate flies to the applicable instrument skill standard while giving accurate instruction and correcting scan/control errors before they grow.

Watch / correct: Changing pitch and power repeatedly without waiting for the result -> make a purposeful change, observe and refine.

Watch / correct: Confusing constant rate with constant airspeed -> restate the assigned target and use the appropriate controlling indication.

Stop / transition: End simulated instrument conditions for traffic/lookout failure, control deterioration, disorientation or an aircraft limitation. Maintain a clearly briefed pilot flying and outside observer.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VI.A-E; Instrument Flying Handbook

Teach intercepts, tracking and DME-arc principles · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Require identification/integrity checks of the selected navigation source and a briefing of the intended intercept/track. Change only a simulated wind or a safe assignment; ask the candidate to diagnose the effect on course tracking.

Student exercise: Demonstrate intercepting and tracking with the aircraft's authorized ground-based or satellite source. Teach wind correction and source/mode verification. When DME-arc practice is applicable and available, explain distance control, lead points and station geometry before coaching a segment.

Practice: One intercept and tracking segment for each available required source; one DME-arc segment if applicable; carry unavailable equipment work to an appropriate aircraft/device.

Look for: Candidate teaches source selection, course/distance control and wind correction while meeting the applicable instrument standard.

Watch / correct: Using the wrong CDI/navigation source -> verify the selected source and active leg before correction.

Watch / correct: Chasing displacement with repeated large heading changes -> use a reasoned intercept and refine the wind correction.

Stop / transition: Discontinue for unreliable/unidentified navigation, unsafe workload or a route conflict. Never invent a procedure or substitute unsupported equipment for a required demonstration.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VII.A; Instrument Flying Handbook; Instrument Procedures Handbook

Teach a nonprecision approach and descent planning · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Require a full approach briefing using current charts/NOTAMs, aircraft category, equipment and minima. Observe the candidate teach course/altitude restrictions, descent planning, missed approach and the required visual transition. Role-play one misidentified waypoint verbally.

Student exercise: Verify source/mode and active procedure, fly the cleared approach, teach the applicable minimum altitude and descent method, and monitor the lateral/vertical path. At the decision point, teach the appropriate missed approach or a legal visual transition.

Practice: One demonstration and one coached approach if routing permits; otherwise one approach with a detailed diagnosis and carry-forward.

Look for: Candidate teaches a current, properly briefed procedure, respects every applicable restriction and makes a timely, lawful missed/landing decision.

Watch / correct: Using a displayed advisory glidepath as permission below a minimum -> explain its status and respect the published/regulatory limits.

Watch / correct: Delaying the missed approach while searching for references -> act at the briefed decision point.

Stop / transition: Miss or discontinue for an unstable approach, wrong source/leg, prohibited descent, loss of required guidance or an unmet visual requirement. Published procedures and actual ATC govern.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VIII.A; Instrument Procedures Handbook chapter 4

Teach precision/vertical-guidance approach management · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Require the candidate to identify the exact approach type and available guidance; do not label every GPS vertical path a precision approach. Brief mode capture, minima, missed procedure and required equipment.

Student exercise: Demonstrate source/mode verification, interception and tracking of the required lateral/vertical guidance. Coach the learner through configuration, stabilized descent and the approach decision, while explaining the indicated trend rather than issuing disconnected corrections.

Practice: One demonstration and one coached approach when available; verify the actual PTS-required approach equipment/type before claiming task coverage.

Look for: Candidate teaches the applicable approach accurately, maintains task limits and chooses missed approach or legal landing at the correct point.

Watch / correct: Assuming the armed mode is active guidance -> confirm capture/annunciation and actual course response.

Watch / correct: Treating LPV, LNAV/VNAV and ILS as interchangeable -> identify the procedure type and applicable task requirements.

Stop / transition: Miss for guidance failure, an unstable path, unmet visual conditions or an aircraft/procedure restriction. Never descend on an invalid or unverified vertical path.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VIII.B; Instrument Procedures Handbook chapter 4

Complete a supported approach or visual return · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Require a current return/approach briefing, aircraft category/equipment, minima if applicable and a missed/landing plan. Observe the candidate's final coaching and protect against fixation on the lesson timer.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches the authorized return, approach or visual pattern, confirms active guidance and approved configuration, makes the landing/missed decision and maintains positive control through rollout.

Practice: One final supported approach/landing or authorized missed/visual alternative; no forced extra approach.

Look for: Actual ATC, approach/visual rules and aircraft limits are respected; teaching stays concise during high workload.

Watch / correct: Trying to finish an explanation below an appropriate workload gate -> fly the approach and discuss later.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or unmet visual conditions -> execute the safe authorized missed/go-around.

Stop / transition: Miss/go around or use the authorized alternative for unstable flight, invalid guidance, unmet required references or runway conflict.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VIII; current charts and aircraft checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E X.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Candidate explains which IPC tasks/equipment are required and identifies all unobserved items without issuing a premature endorsement.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate flies to the applicable instrument skill standard while giving accurate instruction and correcting scan/control errors before they grow.

Debrief • 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- This training flight is not automatically a completed IPC. Use the current ACS IPC table to schedule/observe any remaining required tasks, including holding, unusual attitudes, missed/circling/landing decisions, lost-primary indications and applicable multiengine tasks. Complete required ground assessment and records separately; issue an IPC endorsement only after the full applicable check is satisfactory.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Check the current IPC task table and permitted equipment credit

Flight Instructor Instrument PTS - source page Tasks VI.A, VI.B, VI.C, VI.D, VI.E, VII.A, VIII.A, VIII.B; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-8081-9E, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)

Instrument Rating - Airplane ACS: instrument proficiency check - source page Appendix 1, printed pages 29-30: IPC task table; Appendix 3 equipment/credit limits - FAA-S-ACS-8C; FAA index April 2024/effective May 31, 2024; reviewed October 10, 2026

Lesson 11 · Mock instrument-instructor assessment

[Return to lesson index](#)

120 min check | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Assess instrument checks and taxi clearance	Candidate explains the instrument checks, clearance route and taxi plan; confirms indications/equipment status, briefs hold-short points and stops for any...
08-25 Air 00-17	[] Assess departure and transition to instrument flight	Candidate briefs the cleared departure, flies/teaches the approved takeoff and climb, verifies navigation/modes and transitions to instrument exercise only...
25-95 Air 17-87	[] Assess instrument-instructor teaching across a complete mission	Candidate briefs the task, demonstrates while explaining, supervises the trainer acting as learner, identifies the scripted error and states a justified...
95-115 Air 87-107	[] Complete a supported approach or visual return	Candidate teaches the authorized return, approach or visual pattern, confirms active guidance and approved configuration, makes the landing/missed decision and...
115-120 Ground	[] Assess after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 11

Assess effective IFR teaching, learner-error diagnosis and judgment against the applicable current PTS scope.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Assess effective IFR teaching, learner-error diagnosis and judgment against the applicable current PTS scope.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Determine initial versus added CFII scope from existing instructor ratings; select required approach/navigation and abnormal tasks.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Assess effective IFR teaching, learner-error diagnosis and judgment against the applicable current PTS scope.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Assess instrument checks and taxi clearance · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess independently without coaching new technique; safety intervention ends the assessed attempt. Observe the candidate teach stationary/moving instrument checks using the aircraft checklist and verify the real clearance, navigation source and airport diagram. Act as a learner who overlooks a hold-short or source mismatch only through a verbal cue. Assess independently and record errors; do not coach new technique.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the instrument checks, clearance route and taxi plan; confirms indications/equipment status, briefs hold-short points and stops for any uncertainty before continuing.

Practice: One actual taxi route with each required aircraft instrument check; no head-down programming while moving.

Look for: Checks and clearance/airport route are correctly taught; taxi remains under positive control.

Watch / correct: Head-down setup while moving -> stop in a safe location before programming.

Watch / correct: Check completed without noticing an inconsistent indication -> resolve the indication before dispatch.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for unclear clearance/route, unsafe distraction, abnormal instruments or runway-incursion risk.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E III.C,V.A,X.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Assess departure and transition to instrument flight · 17 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess independently without coaching new technique; safety intervention ends the assessed attempt. Confirm who is pilot flying and outside observer; assess the candidate's teaching of actual clearance, departure path, approved speeds/configuration and view-device timing. Prevent a scenario instruction from replacing the real clearance. Assess independently and record errors; do not coach new technique.

Student exercise: Candidate briefs the cleared departure, flies/teaches the approved takeoff and climb, verifies navigation/modes and transitions to instrument exercise only after workload and lookout responsibilities are established.

Practice: One authorized departure/transit; instrument time begins only under actual qualifying conditions.

Look for: Candidate teaches the correct path/configuration and establishes a stable instrument scan without losing clearance or lookout protection.

Watch / correct: Discussing the lesson while missing a clearance restriction -> fly/comply first and shorten instruction.

Watch / correct: Using a view device before a safe observer/control arrangement -> defer device use until responsibilities are clear.

Stop / transition: Discontinue the exercise for an actual clearance conflict, control deterioration, unsafe weather/equipment or lookout failure.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E V.A-B,VI; aircraft departure checklist; 91.109 as applicable

Assess instrument-instructor teaching across a complete mission · 70 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess without coaching new technique. Select the required PTS tasks for the applicant's existing instructor ratings and available equipment. Use an authorized IFR/simulated-IFR mission, a learner-error case and one safely simulated abnormality; state any tasks deferred to another flight. Record pilot performance, teaching accuracy, learner-error diagnosis and risk decisions separately. Intervene immediately for safety; intervention ends that assessed attempt.

Student exercise: Candidate briefs the task, demonstrates while explaining, supervises the trainer acting as learner, identifies the scripted error and states a justified assessment/correction. Maintain checklist discipline, control transfers and outside/flight-path scan throughout.

Practice: One assessed demonstration and one learner-error case for each selected task; unobserved items remain unobserved.

Look for: Candidate performs to the instrument instructor standard while giving effective teaching, recognizes/corrects the learner error and complies with the real clearance and applicable equipment/minima requirements.

Watch / correct: Deviation outside the task standard -> record the evidence and assign remediation; do not coach it into a pass.

Watch / correct: Inaccurate explanation or missed learner hazard -> record the teaching deficiency and stop before it becomes an aircraft-control hazard.

Stop / transition: Stop for safety intervention, aircraft/clearance limit, traffic or unsuitable conditions. Record deferred tasks separately from unsuccessful tasks; the clock does not grant completion.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E V-X and additional-rating table

Complete a supported approach or visual return · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess independently without coaching new technique; safety intervention ends the assessed attempt. Require a current return/approach briefing, aircraft category/equipment, minima if applicable and a missed/landing plan. Observe the candidate's final coaching and protect against fixation on the lesson timer. Assess independently and record errors; do not coach new technique.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches the authorized return, approach or visual pattern, confirms active guidance and approved configuration, makes the landing/missed decision and maintains positive control through rollout.

Practice: One final supported approach/landing or authorized missed/visual alternative; no forced extra approach.

Look for: Actual ATC, approach/visual rules and aircraft limits are respected; teaching stays concise during high workload.

Watch / correct: Trying to finish an explanation below an appropriate workload gate -> fly the approach and discuss later.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or unmet visual conditions -> execute the safe authorized missed/go-around.

Stop / transition: Miss/go around or use the authorized alternative for unstable flight, invalid guidance, unmet required references or runway conflict.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VIII; current charts and aircraft checklist

Assess after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess independently without coaching new technique; safety intervention ends the assessed attempt. Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up. Assess independently and record errors; do not coach new technique.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E X.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Assessment is independent: safety intervention, prompting or an unobserved required item cannot be recorded as a satisfactory task.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate performs to the instrument instructor standard while giving effective teaching, recognizes/corrects the learner error and complies with the real clearance and applicable equipment/minima requirements.

Debrief • 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- Unobserved required tasks need a separate assessment; satisfactory timing does not establish practical-test eligibility.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor Instrument PTS - source page Tasks V.A, V.B, VI.A, VI.B, VI.C, VI.D, VI.E, VI.F, VI.G, VI.H, VII.A, VII.B, VIII.A, VIII.B, VIII.C, VIII.D, VIII.E, IX.A, IX.B, X.A; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-8081-9E, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)

Lesson 12 · Conditional multiengine instrument instruction

[Return to lesson index](#)

120 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Ground	[] Teach instrument checks and taxi clearance	Candidate explains the instrument checks, clearance route and taxi plan; confirms indications/equipment status, briefs hold-short points and stops for any...
08-25 Air 00-17	[] Teach departure and transition to instrument flight	Candidate briefs the cleared departure, flies/teaches the approved takeoff and climb, verifies navigation/modes and transitions to instrument exercise only...
25-75 Air 17-67	[] Teach multiengine instrument control and OEI approach	Teach recognition and control of a simulated engine failure during instrument straight flight/turns.
75-95 Air 67-87	[] Teach a loss-of-communications decision without guessing clearance	Maintain aircraft control; verify the simulated failure; identify available communication alternatives; explain and apply the appropriate rule/procedure to the...
95-115 Air 87-107	[] Complete a supported approach or visual return	Candidate teaches the authorized return, approach or visual pattern, confirms active guidance and approved configuration, makes the landing/missed decision and...
115-120 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 12

For a multiengine instrument-instructor application/equipment scope, teach OEI instrument control and a supported approach.

Conditional multiengine CFII flight: omit for a single-engine-only scope; use appropriately rated trainers, actual equipment and the applicable PTS task selection.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- For a multiengine instrument-instructor application/equipment scope, teach OEI instrument control and a supported approach.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Verify multiengine pilot/instructor qualifications, aircraft suitability, approved OEI simulation and required IX.C-D applicability.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- For a multiengine instrument-instructor application/equipment scope, teach OEI instrument control and a supported approach.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach instrument checks and taxi clearance · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach stationary/moving instrument checks using the aircraft checklist and verify the real clearance, navigation source and airport diagram. Act as a learner who overlooks a hold-short or source mismatch only through a verbal cue.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the instrument checks, clearance route and taxi plan; confirms indications/equipment status, briefs hold-short points and stops for any uncertainty before continuing.

Practice: One actual taxi route with each required aircraft instrument check; no head-down programming while moving.

Look for: Checks and clearance/airport route are correctly taught; taxi remains under positive control.

Watch / correct: Head-down setup while moving -> stop in a safe location before programming.

Watch / correct: Check completed without noticing an inconsistent indication -> resolve the indication before dispatch.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for unclear clearance/route, unsafe distraction, abnormal instruments or runway-incursion risk.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E III.C,V.A,X.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach departure and transition to instrument flight · 17 minutes

Teach / coach: Confirm who is pilot flying and outside observer; assess the candidate's teaching of actual clearance, departure path, approved speeds/configuration and view-device timing. Prevent a scenario instruction from replacing the real clearance.

Student exercise: Candidate briefs the cleared departure, flies/teaches the approved takeoff and climb, verifies navigation/modes and transitions to instrument exercise only after workload and lookout responsibilities are established.

Practice: One authorized departure/transit; instrument time begins only under actual qualifying conditions.

Look for: Candidate teaches the correct path/configuration and establishes a stable instrument scan without losing clearance or lookout protection.

Watch / correct: Discussing the lesson while missing a clearance restriction -> fly/comply first and shorten instruction.

Watch / correct: Using a view device before a safe observer/control arrangement -> defer device use until responsibilities are clear.

Stop / transition: Discontinue the exercise for an actual clearance conflict, control deterioration, unsafe weather/equipment or lookout failure.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E V.A-B,VI; aircraft departure checklist; 91.109 as applicable

Teach multiengine instrument control and OEI approach · 50 minutes

Teach / coach: Use an appropriately rated trainer and a suitable multiengine airplane. Verify IFR/engine-out equipment and performance, approved simulation/zero-thrust values and safe recovery/landing options. Require the candidate to brief the one-engine approach and communications implications.

Student exercise: Teach recognition and control of a simulated engine failure during instrument straight flight/turns. Identify/verify using the aircraft procedure, reduce workload and fly a supported approach with the approved OEI profile. Coach the learner through a decision to land or use the prebriefed safe alternative.

Practice: One instrument OEI control sequence and one supported OEI approach; do not force a second approach into the block.

Look for: Candidate teaches instrument control and the aircraft-specific failure/approach sequence while respecting guidance, minima and performance limits.

Watch / correct: Diagnosing the engine while the instrument path deteriorates -> stabilize control first.

Watch / correct: Assuming an OEI missed approach is available -> verify aircraft performance and brief a safe alternative before dispatch.

Stop / transition: Multiengine only. Terminate for unreliable indications, wrong-engine selection, control/airspeed-margin loss or unsupported OEI climb/approach. Any actual failure replaces simulation with the aircraft emergency procedure.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E IX.C-D; AFH chapter 13; Instrument Procedures Handbook

Teach a loss-of-communications decision without guessing clearance · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Use a prebriefed scenario card and clearly distinguish simulated silence from a real radio failure. Ask the candidate to teach VMC/IMC decision differences, troubleshooting, route/altitude and clearance-limit reasoning using current references.

Student exercise: Maintain aircraft control; verify the simulated failure; identify available communication alternatives; explain and apply the appropriate rule/procedure to the scenario. Teach how current weather, fuel and landing options affect the decision.

Practice: One VMC and one IMC verbal scenario while following the actual authorized flight path; do not intentionally stop complying with ATC.

Look for: Candidate gives a regulation-supported route/altitude/landing plan, maintains flight control and does not confuse a scenario clearance with the real clearance.

Watch / correct: Reciting a mnemonic without resolving the clearance limit -> work through the actual clearance and rule.

Watch / correct: Changing route during a pretend radio failure -> keep actual ATC compliance while discussing the simulated decision.

Stop / transition: Actual communications failure or clearance uncertainty ends role-play. Apply current rules and available assistance; do not deviate merely to enact a scenario.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E IX.A; current 14 CFR 91.185 and AIM

Complete a supported approach or visual return · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Require a current return/approach briefing, aircraft category/equipment, minima if applicable and a missed/landing plan. Observe the candidate's final coaching and protect against fixation on the lesson timer.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches the authorized return, approach or visual pattern, confirms active guidance and approved configuration, makes the landing/missed decision and maintains positive control through rollout.

Practice: One final supported approach/landing or authorized missed/visual alternative; no forced extra approach.

Look for: Actual ATC, approach/visual rules and aircraft limits are respected; teaching stays concise during high workload.

Watch / correct: Trying to finish an explanation below an appropriate workload gate -> fly the approach and discuss later.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or unmet visual conditions -> execute the safe authorized missed/go-around.

Stop / transition: Miss/go around or use the authorized alternative for unstable flight, invalid guidance, unmet required references or runway conflict.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E VIII; current charts and aircraft checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-8081-9E X.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate teaches instrument control and the aircraft-specific failure/approach sequence while respecting guidance, minima and performance limits.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- Omit this flight for a single-engine-only equipment/application scope; no multiengine task completion is claimed in that branch.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor Instrument PTS - source page Tasks IX.C, IX.D, IX.A; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-8081-9E, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)